WORKSHOP HANDOUT

Decentralized curation

Putting self-interest to work for the public good.

Institute of Open Science Practices (IOSP) 2026, Leiden · Wednesday 14 October 2026, 14:00 to 15:20

Who judges what matters?

Curating public goods requires judging both factual claims and relevance to a shared purpose. How can those judgments earn trust when participants have their own interests? **Decentralized Curation aims for credible judgment without trusting individual participants or requiring permission to take part.**

Curating public goods

1. **Set the policy.** Define what matters, what evidence is needed and how assessors are rewarded.
2. **Nominate work.** Anyone can identify a contribution, publish claims and evidence, and put down a deposit. Claims can enter before being fact-checked.
3. **Judge relevance.** People lock tokens they risk losing to enter the jury lottery. Selected jurors score independently under the policy.
4. **Keep scores current.** Renew scores periodically. Anyone can fund an objection; competing funded proposals trigger an appeal with a larger jury.
5. **Publish the assessment.** Express how much each eligible contribution matters relative to the others under the policy.
6. **Challenge facts at any time.** Anyone can challenge an active nomination's claims. An external arbitrator decides. A false or untestable claim closes that nomination and forfeits its deposit. A fresh nomination is allowed.

Crowd curation produces relative weights

NumPy	arXiv	Linux
0.50	0.30	0.20
50%	30%	20%

0.50 + 0.30 + 0.20 = 1.00

Illustrative normalized weights under one policy, not raw jury scores or measured public benefit. Funding is one later use of this assessment.

One example: research infrastructure

How much does this nominee's completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

Consider 1	Consider 2	Consider 3
how many rely	role in research	other options

0.00	not infrastructure
0.25	matters to one field
0.50	relied on in several fields
0.75	widely relied on
1.00	critical across research

Each pool chooses its own policy. Policy context and attribution.

Today: try relevance scoring

1 Read the policy	2 Score alone
3 Seal your score	4 Reveal together

An equal-seat points game about relevance scoring. Full jury selection, accuracy disputes, appeals and funding are outside this exercise.

Use an alias or observe. Revealed scores and standings are public; role-play may be assigned. Keep score proofs private; ask before photos. The host wipes results afterward.

What did the incentives reward?

Evidence or simply agreement? Agreement proves neither truth nor public benefit. Reliable judgment and resistance to collusion still need testing.

Try, read, stay in touch

The room

Published preprint

Mailing list

Room: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/r/leiden

Join: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/join/

Published preprint, version 1.2.0: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23313625.

Release source · Public mechanism and evidence limits. Later hardening is outside this archived release.

Sponsored by Octant

Decentralized Curation research by Ferit Tunçer.

Copyright (C) 2026 Ferit Tunçer. Licence: code GPL-3.0-or-later, original text and figures CC BY 4.0; third-party marks excluded. https://decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev